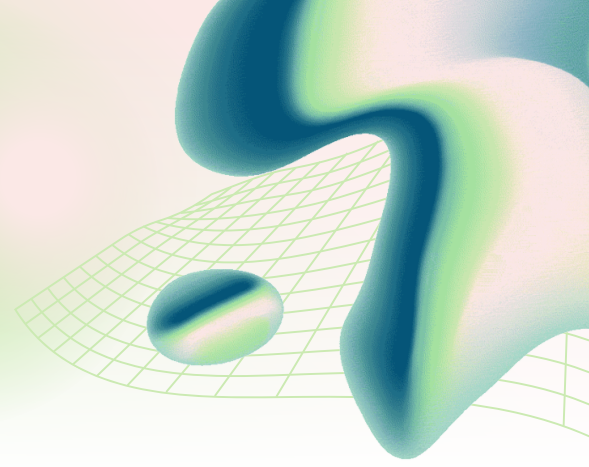


GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

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1. High-Level Overview

Genre

- Turn-Based Tactical Strategy
- Board-Based Strategy
- Chess-Inspired (Not a Chess Clone)

Core Concept

Eternal Check is a turn-based strategic board game where players command fantasy units on a dynamic, shrinking battlefield. The game emphasizes planning, positioning, ability management, and long-term decision-making, rather than luck, speed, or reflexes.

While inspired by the structural clarity of chess (grid, unit archetypes), the game introduces flexible movement, independent attack systems, abilities, shared cooldowns, and dynamic win conditions, creating a modern tactical experience.

Platforms

- PC (Primary)
- Mobile (Planned)
- Multiplayer support planned after core gameplay stability

2. Design Goals

- Deliver a deep, skill-based tactical experience
- Eliminate randomness; outcomes are driven by player decisions
- Encourage:
 - Strategic foresight
 - Risk vs reward choices
 - Long-term planning over short-term gains
- Combine:
 - Classic board-game structure
 - Modern ability-driven mechanics
 - Dynamic battlefield changes

3. Board & Grid System

Grid Layout

- 10 × 10 grid (100 tiles)
- Tile-based movement, combat, and abilities
- Designed initially for Single Player vs AI
- Multiplayer uses identical core systems

Zone Shrinking Mechanic

After a fixed number of turns (example: Turn 10), the battlefield begins collapsing inward.

Shrink Phases

1. Warning Phase
 - Visual indicators highlight tiles that will collapse
2. Cracked Phase
 - Tiles visually fracture, signaling imminent destruction
3. Tile Removal
 - Tiles disappear from the board

Effects on Units

- Units standing on removed tiles:
 - Take damage over time
 - Some fragile units (e.g., Pawns) may die instantly

 Reference Images:

- 10×10 grid top-down mockup
- 3-stage zone collapse diagram

4. Unit Roster (Temporary Names)

Unit Type	Count
King	1
Queen	1
Rook	2
Bishop	2
Knight	2
Pawn	8

5. Turn-Based Action Rules

- Each player takes turns
- Only ONE main action per turn:
 - Move OR

- Attack
- On subsequent turns, players may:
 - Repeat the same action
 - Switch actions

Abilities

- Activated outside the main action
- Governed by cooldowns and usage rules

6. Movement System

- Each unit has a predefined movement range
- Movement is independent of attack capability

Example Ranges (Subject to Balance)

- Queen → High range
- King → Medium range
- Pawn → Low range

Reference Images:

- Movement range overlays per unit

7. Attack System

- Attack range is separate from movement
- Different units and abilities use unique attack patterns

Possible Attack Patterns

- Circular radius

- Box-shaped area
- Diagonal-only directions
- Edge-only or boundary attacks
- Ability-exclusive patterns

📌 Reference Images:

- Attack pattern diagrams over grid

8. Ability System

Ability Categories

Global Abilities

- Affect the entire board or all units
- Turn-based cooldowns
- Cannot be reused until cooldown expires

Unit Abilities

Each unit has:

- Primary Ability
- Secondary Ability

Ability Rules

Primary Ability

- Can be used only once per unit per match
- Paired units (Rook, Bishop, Knight, Pawn):
 - Share the same primary ability
 - If one unit uses it, the paired unit permanently loses access

Secondary Ability

- Reusable after cooldown
- Cooldown is shared between paired units

Example Ability Concepts (Not Final)

- Earthquake
- Poison
- Healing
- Sub-Unit Spawn (temporary micro-units for offense/defense)

📌 Reference Images:

- Ability effect previews
- Cooldown UI visualization

9. Unit Unlocking System

Players do not start with the full roster.

Example Starting Setup

- 1 King
 - 4 Pawns
 - 1 additional unit of choice
- ➡ Total: 6 starting units

Unlock Progression

- Additional units unlock based on turn count
- Example:
 - Turn 5 → Unit unlock
 - Turn 7 → Unit unlock
 - Turn 9 → Unit unlock

📌 Reference Images:

- Unlock progression timeline

10. Win Conditions

1. King Defeat

- Defeating the enemy King ends the match instantly

2. Zone Collapse Survival

- Outlast the opponent as the battlefield shrinks

11. Turn Timer

- Each turn has a time limit
- Estimated: 12–15 seconds
- Final value determined through playtesting

12. AI Boss Faction

Faction Name

The Void Sovereignty (AI-only)

Core Features

- Multi-phase Boss King
- Reality-warping abilities
- Board destruction mechanics

Boss Phases

- Control & probing
- Aggressive counterplay

- Board annihilation

13. UI / UX Design

Core Philosophy

- Terrain communicates gameplay information
- Minimal HUD
- No permanent grid overlay

Visual Communication

- Movement → terrain glow, runes, dust
- Attack range → shadows, markings
- Abilities → particles, sigils, audio cues
- Fog of War → mist and darkness

Reference Images:

- Terrain-based UI mockups
- Fog-of-war comparisons

14. Audio & Visual Direction

Visual Style

- Stylized dark fantasy
- Clear silhouettes
- Non-horror tone

Audio Design

- Ambient tension
- Ability-based sound cues
- Escalating music during zone collapse

15. Technical Design Notes

- Grid-based deterministic logic
- Turn-synchronized multiplayer-ready
- Replay & spectator support
- Unreal Engine 5.6
- C++ + Blueprint hybrid architecture

16. Team Structure

Name	Role	Responsibilities
Vasanth	Designer	Assets, UI, visual design
Abikarthick	Developer	Gameplay, UI, VFX, SFX
Dhanush	Developer	Gameplay, UI
TBD	QA / Support	Testing, level design

17. Team Structure

Development Timeline (4-Person Team)

● Milestone 1 – Core Prototype (Weeks 1–3)

- Grid system
- Turn logic
- Movement & attack
- Basic AI

● Milestone 2 – Abilities & Zone (Weeks 4–6)

- Ability framework
- Cooldowns
- Zone shrinking
- Health & damage

● Milestone 3 – UI & Visual Pass (Weeks 7–9)

- Terrain-based UI
- Ability VFX
- Audio cues

● Milestone 4 – AI Boss & Polish (Weeks 10–12)

- Boss phases
- Balancing
- Bug fixes
- Playtest build

● Milestone 5 – Multiplayer (Optional)

- Turn sync
- Lobby system
- Optimization